Past Continuous

Past Continuous + when — الحدث المُقاطِع

Level 2 — with when

Name: _____ Date: _____

1 Definition · التعريف

حدثٌ طويل كان جاريًا (ماضٍ مستمر) يقطعه حدثٌ قصير وقع فجأة (ماضٍ بسيط)، ونربط بينهما بـ when.

A long action in progress (past continuous) is interrupted by a short action (past simple), joined with when.

was / were + V-ing + when + past simple

2 Key Facts · حقائق أساسية

★ الحدث الطويل الجاري ← ماضٍ مستمر · الحدث القصير المقاطِع ← ماضٍ بسيط.

Long background action = past continuous; short interrupting action = past simple.

★ when يسبق الحدث القصير في الماضي البسيط.

when comes before the short action in the past simple.

★ ترتيبان للجملة: [continuous + when + simple] أو [When + simple, continuous].

Two orders: continuous + when + simple, OR When + simple, continuous.

★ إذا بدأت الجملة بـ When نضع فاصلة بعد العبارة الأولى.

When the sentence starts with When, put a comma after the first clause.

When + simple, continuous	continuous + when + simple
When the alarm rang, I was sleeping.	I was sleeping when the alarm rang.
When I arrived, she was cooking.	She was cooking when I arrived.

3 Steps · خطوات النجاح

الخلفية الطويلة → was/were + V-ing. المقاطعة القصيرة بعد when → past simple.

Long background → was/were + V-ing. Short interruption after when → past simple.

مقاطعة

I was reading when the lights went out.

مقاطعة

She was cooking when the guests arrived.

بادئة بـ When

When the teacher came in, we were talking.

4 Summary · الخلاصة

✦ تذكّر/ي دائمًا · Remember

was/were + V-ing + when + past simple ← حدثٌ طويل وقطعه حدثٌ قصير.

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Let's Practice!

1 Recognize · تعرّف

Choose the past continuous (long) or the past simple (short).
اختر/ي الماضي المستمر (الطويل) أو البسيط (القصير).

1. I ____ TV when she called. (was watching / watched)
2. The phone rang when I ____ . (was sleeping / slept)
3. When the bell ____ , we were leaving. (was ringing / rang)
4. They ____ when it started to rain. (were playing / played)

2 Multiple Choice · اختيار من متعدد

Choose the correct verb form.
اختر/ي صيغة الفعل الصحيحة.

1. I was cooking when the phone ____ . a) was ringing b) rang
2. When the rain started, we ____ outside. a) were playing b) played
3. She ____ a letter when I arrived. a) was writing b) wrote

3 Fill in · إكمال الفراغ

Use the past continuous for the long action and the past simple for the short one.
استخدم/ي الماضي المستمر للحدث الطويل والبسيط للقصير.

1. I _____ (sleep) when the earthquake _____ (happen).
2. We _____ (have) dinner when you _____ (call).
3. When the teacher _____ (enter), the students _____ (talk).
4. She _____ (read) when the lights _____ (go) out.

4 Match · توصيل

Match each clause with its ending — write the letter.
صِل/ي كل بداية بنهايتها — اكتب/ي الحرف.

1) I was riding my bike	____	a) when the phone rang.
2) We were sleeping	____	b) when I fell down.
3) When the bell rang,	____	c) we were leaving class.

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Keep Going!

5 Transform · تحويل

Join the two sentences with when.
اربط/ي الجملتين بـ when.

1. I was cooking. The phone rang. → .....

2. We were walking home. It started to rain. → .....

6 Correct · تصحيح خطأ

Each sentence has one mistake. Correct it.
في كل جملة خطأ واحد. صحّح/يه.

1. I was read when she called. → .....

2. They was playing when it started to snow. → .....

3. When I was cooking, I was cutting my finger. → .....

7 In Context · توظيف سياقي

Use the past continuous or the past simple for each verb.
استخدم/ي الماضي المستمر أو البسيط لكل فعل.

Last night our street was quiet. I (1) _____ (do) my homework when the lights suddenly (2) _____ (go) off. My mother (3) _____ (look) for a candle when my father (4) _____ (come) home. We (5) _____ (sit) together when the power finally (6) _____ (return).

8 Create · تحدٍ إبداعي

Write 2 sentences with when about yesterday.
اكتب/ي جملتين بـ when عن أمس.

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Answer Key

🔑 Answer Key · مفتاح الإجابات للمعلمة

تمرين ١: was watching · was sleeping · rang · were playing

تمرين ٢: b) rang · a) were playing · a) was writing

تمرين ٣: was sleeping / happened · were having / called · entered / were talking · was reading / went

تمرين ٤: 1 → b · 2 → a · 3 → c

تمرين ٥: I was cooking when the phone rang. · We were walking home when it started to rain.

تمرين ٦: I was reading when she called. · They were playing when it started to snow. · When I was cooking, I cut my finger.

تمرين ٧: 1 was doing · 2 went · 3 was looking · 4 came · 5 were sitting · 6 returned

تمرين ٨: إجابات مفتوحة! (continuous + *when* + past simple).

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